

Day 4 — Mini-Capstone: PRD Assembly (Non-AI)

Activity packet for participant triads. Today's job: complete the remaining PRD sections, integrate the whole document, and lock the version that goes into Friday's review. **No AI**, all day.

Where we are in the week

Sections 1–7 are drafted. Today adds:

- **Section 8 Metrics & validation** — how we'll know it worked in 30 days
- **Section 9 Risks & open questions** — named honestly
- **Section 10 Dependencies** — other teams, systems, decisions, data
- **Section 11 Out-of-scope follow-ups** — what this PRD acknowledges but won't ship

And then the **integration pass**: read the whole PRD top-to-bottom, fix incoherences, lock a version for tomorrow's review.

The non-AI rule (final day)

This is the keystone day. Tomorrow is reviews; AI is restored Monday. Today the discipline holds.

What's allowed today: spell-check, your prior-week artifacts, your draft sections, dictionary, calculator, conversations across triads.

What's not: ChatGPT, Claude, Copilot, AI features built into your editor (turn them off), or asking another team's AI for "just a structure."

Activity 1 — Section 8: Metrics & Validation

Format: Triad • 35 min • Block 1

Purpose

Connect the PRD to the **Tier Sheet from Week 2 Day 1** and the **NS from Week 2 Day 2**. This section is what Week 7's Agile Delivery work will measure against.

Setup

Each triad needs the Week-2 Tier Sheet, the NS Defense Card, and the Section 8 template. No AI.

What Section 8 contains

8. Metrics & validation

Primary metric (the one we're trying to move)

> [Single op-signal or KPI from your Tier Sheet]

> Baseline: <current value>

> Target: <30-day target>

> Why this number: <2-sentence defense>

Counter-metric (the guardrail)

> [Counter-metric from your NS Defense Card]

> If this moves *the wrong way*, we are winning the primary for the wrong reasons.

Secondary metrics (3 max)

- <op-signal 1>: directional indicator

- <op-signal 2>: directional indicator

- <op-signal 3>: directional indicator

Validation plan

- **Pre-launch:** smoke tests (link to AC verification)

- **Launch + 7 days:** check primary metric directional correctness

- **Launch + 30 days:** measure primary against target

- **Launch + 90 days:** check counter-metric for guardrail violation

What "good enough" looks like

We'll consider this feature successful if [primary metric] moves $\geq$ [target delta] within 30 days, AND [counter-metric] stays within [acceptable band].

Triad protocol

1. **Pull from Tier Sheet** (10 min). Pick the primary metric, the counter, and 3 secondaries.
2. **Set targets** (15 min). Concrete numbers, with a sentence of defense.
3. **Validation plan** (10 min). The four-checkpoint cadence above.

What "good" looks like

- Primary metric is **one** number, not "we'll watch a few things."
- Targets are **specific deltas**, not "improve."
- Counter-metric is the same one from Week 2 Day 2 — consistency.

Deliverable

Section 8 appended to the PRD: one primary metric, one counter-metric, up to three secondaries, and a four-checkpoint validation plan.

Activity 2 — Section 9: Risks & Open Questions

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 2

Purpose

Name the things that could go wrong, the things you don't yet know, and the things you'll find out only after launch. **A PRD with "no risks" is a fail.**

Setup

Each triad needs Sections 1–8 and the three-list template (Risks, Open questions, Assumptions). No AI.

Three lists in Section 9

Risks (named, with mitigation):

Risk	Likelihood (L/M/H)	Impact (L/M/H)	Mitigation
Dispatchers refuse the new flow because it's longer	M	H	Optional toggle in v1; observe adoption; remove old flow only if adoption > 70% by week 4
Audit-log volume blows our log budget	L	M	Tier-2 sample for non-error events; full sample for errors
Auth integration breaks if SSO IdP changes	L	H	Pre-coordinate with SecOps; document fallback to local auth

Open questions (we don't know yet; need to answer before or during build):

- Will operations VP accept the temporary read-only manager view in week 1?
(Owner: <name>; needed by: <date>)
- Does the audit store handle 24-month retention at this volume, or do we need archival tier?
(Owner: <name>; needed by: <date>)

Assumptions (things we're treating as true; we'll learn if we're wrong):

- Median dispatcher device is mid-tier Android on 4G LTE (basis: device-fleet snapshot Q3; revisit if changes)
- 30-day adoption signal is sufficient to declare success (basis: prior reconcile rollout; revisit if behavior is non-stationary)

Triad protocol

1. **Risks brainstorm** (15 min). Aim for 5 candidates. Cull to 3–4 with non-trivial impact.
2. **Open questions** (10 min). Each member contributes; pool. 3–5 questions.
3. **Assumptions** (10 min). Often the hardest section — what are we taking for granted?
4. **Owner + by-when assignment** (5 min). Every open question and risk gets an owner and a deadline.

Deliverable

Section 9 appended to the PRD: 3–4 risks with mitigations, 3–5 owned open questions with deadlines, and 2–4 named assumptions with basis.

Activity 3 — Sections 10 & 11: Dependencies + Out-of-Scope Follow-ups

Format: Triad • 40 min • Block 3

Purpose

Make the network of "things outside our PRD that this PRD depends on or hands off to" explicit. Most PRDs hand-wave this; mature ones tabulate.

Setup

Each triad needs Section 3 (non-goals), Section 4 (scope), and any cross-team context surfaced during the week. No AI.

Section 10 Dependencies

A simple table:

10. Dependencies

Dependency	Owner	What we need	By when	Status
Auth team – SSO scope addition	<name>	New scope `reconcile.write`	Week of build kickoff	Confirmed in Slack 2026-04-15
Data platform – event schema	<name>	Schema review for 7 new events	Day 1 of sprint 1	Pending
Mobile build pipeline – signing	<name>	New signing cert for the new bundle ID	Pre-launch	Pending
Customer success – release messaging	<name>	Customer comms 1 week pre-launch	T-7 days	Pending

Section 11 Out-of-scope follow-ups

What this PRD acknowledges but won't ship:

11. Out-of-scope follow-ups (for the backlog)

- **Tablet layout** – same flow, different breakpoint. Tracked: TICKET-1234.
- **Spanish localization** – copy + reading order. Tracked: TICKET-1235.
- **Multi-shop manager view** – pulls reconcile data across shops. Tracked: TICKET-1236.
- **Offline-first sync** – current PRD supports offline draft + manual reconnect; full offline-first deferred. Tracked: TICKET-1237.

Triad protocol

1. **Dependencies** (20 min). Brainstorm the dependency network. For each: owner, what, when, status.
2. **Out-of-scope follow-ups** (15 min). Pull from Section 3 non-goals + Section 4 scope-out + anything that came up this week.
3. **Status sanity check** (5 min). Have you confirmed any of these? If not, "Pending" is honest.

What "good" looks like

- Every dependency has a **named owner**, not a team name.
- "Status" is honest — most will be Pending. That's fine; pretending they're confirmed is the bug.
- Out-of-scope items are **specific**, not "future work."

Deliverable

Sections 10 and 11 appended to the PRD: dependency table with named owners and honest statuses, plus a specific out-of-scope follow-up list.

Activity 4 — Integration Pass + Lock

Format: Triad • 45 min + Wrap • Block 4

Purpose

Read the whole PRD top-to-bottom. Fix incoherences. Lock the version that goes into Friday's review.

Setup

Each triad needs the full Sections 1–11 draft, the eight-item integration checklist, and the AI-prose tell list. No AI.

The integration checklist

Check	Pass criterion
Section 1 → Section 2 flow	Reader is motivated to keep reading
Section 3 goals tied to Section 8 metrics	Each goal references a metric; each metric references a goal
Section 5 sketch consistent with Section 6 AC	Each happy-path AC corresponds to a step in the sketch
Section 6 AC vs Section 7 NFRs	NFRs cover what AC don't (system properties vs system behavior)
Section 7 NFRs reference Section 8 observability	Observability NFR enables every Tier Sheet metric
Section 4 scope-out feeds Section 11 follow-ups	Items deliberately left out appear in the follow-ups list
Section 9 risks named, owned, mitigated	No "no risks"
No AI-generic prose	Voice is consistent triad voice; no fortune-cookie sentences

Triad protocol

1. **Solo read-through** (15 min). Each member reads the whole PRD top-to-bottom and marks issues in the margins.
2. **Pool issues** (10 min). What did each member catch? De-dupe.
3. **Fix in priority order** (15 min). Coherence first, then prose.
4. **Lock the version** (5 min). Mark the document **Status: In review**. Save a copy as "v0 — for Friday".

The "no AI-generic prose" check

Specific tells of AI prose that should be eliminated:

- "It is important to note that..."
- "By leveraging X, we can unlock Y..."
- "This robust solution will empower stakeholders to..."
- "In today's fast-paced environment..."
- Three adjectives in a row when one would do
- Sentences that sound true but say nothing specific

If a section sounds like it could appear in any PRD for any product, rewrite it for *your* product.

Deliverable

Locked **Status: In review** PRD saved as "v0 — for Friday" with the integration checklist passed and no AI-generic prose.

Wrap (last 15 min)

Each triad shares:

- The **section they're proudest of** (1 sentence why)
- The **section they're least sure about** (1 sentence why) — this is the section reviewers should hammer tomorrow

End-of-day checkpoint

Each triad ships into Friday's review:

- ✓ **Status: In review** PRD with Sections 1–11 complete
- ✓ Section 8 Metrics with primary, counter, secondary, validation plan
- ✓ Section 9 Risks (with mitigations) + Open Questions (with owners) + Assumptions
- ✓ Section 10 Dependencies table with owners

- ✓ Section 11 Out-of-scope follow-ups, specific
- ✓ Integration check passed; no AI-generic prose
- ✓ A copy saved as "v0 — for Friday"